

HOUSE RESOLUTION 173

By Todd

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend the Tennessee Century Farms Program on the occasion of its fiftieth anniversary.

WHEREAS, the members of this legislative body take great pride in honoring those programs and institutions that preserve and promote the rich history and heritage of our State; and

WHEREAS, agriculture has long stood at the heart of Tennessee's economy, culture, and identity, shaping communities in every county and sustaining generations of families; and

WHEREAS, established in 1975, the Tennessee Century Farms Program was created to recognize farms that have remained in continuous operation by the same family for 100 years or more, thereby honoring the perseverance, stewardship, and dedications of Tennessee farm families; and

WHEREAS, the program has certified more than 2,300 farms, with at least one Century Farm located in every Tennessee county, reflecting the enduring strength and widespread legacy of family farming across the Volunteer State; and

WHEREAS, the Tennessee Century Farms Program works in partnership with the Department of Agriculture to ensure that these farm families receive formal recognition for their longstanding contributions to Tennessee agriculture; and

WHEREAS, under the distinguished leadership of Dr. Carroll Van West at the Center for Historic Preservation at Middle Tennessee State University (MTSU), the Tennessee Century Farms Program has become a nationally respected model for rural preservation; and

WHEREAS, the Tennessee Century Farms Program has strengthened rural preservation efforts, encouraged further historic recognition through National Register listings,

provided valuable hands-on training opportunities for graduate students, and deepened Tennesseans' appreciation for the central role of agriculture in our shared history; and

WHEREAS, as the Tennessee Century Farms Program celebrates its fiftieth anniversary, the program continues to identify and honor additional eligible farms, ensuring that Tennessee's agricultural heritage will be documented and celebrated for generations to come; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we honor and commend MTSU's Center for Historic Preservation and its Tennessee Century Farms Program upon the celebration of the program's fiftieth anniversary and extend our sincere appreciation to Dr. Carroll Van West and the many farm families whose dedication has preserved our State's proud agricultural legacy.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy.